

3.2.8 Classification is a means of organising the variety of life based on relationships between organisms and is built round the concept of species.

Principles of taxonomy	The principles and importance of taxonomy. Classification systems consist of a hierarchy in which groups are contained within larger composite groups and there is no overlap. The phylogenetic groups are based on patterns of evolutionary history. A species may be defined in terms of observable similarities and the ability to produce fertile offspring. One hierarchy comprises Kingdom, Phylum, Class, Order, Family, Genus, Species. Candidates should be able to appreciate the difficulties of defining species and the tentative nature of classifying organisms as distinct species.
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